



ANACHRONISM

BY AMSI

2025-2026

Anachronism

An AMSI initiative

The Heads:

Rasha Daou

Maha Jarjous

Abdalrahman Al Zamqan

Omar Abdelati

Table of Contents:

- Victorian Era & Cyberpunk Fashion: Grace and Glitch
 - Written by Ansam Salim 9A
- Ancient Greece & Genetic Engineering: The Code of the Gods
 - Written by Caline Leondarides 8F
- Ancient Mesopotamia & Cloud Computing: The Sky Trap
 - Written by Dana Samman 8A
- The Renaissance & Virtual Reality Education: Learning Beyond Time
 - Written by Hana Elseidi 9A
- The Cold War Vs. Social Media Propaganda
 - Written by Razan Al Zubaidi 8F
- The Civil War & Drones for Reconnaissance: If the Civil War Had Drones
 - Written by Roaa Kair 8A
- The Middle Ages and the Internet of Things
 - Written by Sarra Aouili 8A
- The Age of Exploration: From Earth to Space
 - Written by Sidra Kair 8C
- The Harlem Renaissance & Digital Music Production
 - Written by Wid Samaan 9A

Victorian Era and Cyberpunk Fashion: Grace & Glitch



Ansam Salim 9A

My court appearance was always more than a matter of taste; it was a declaration of power. Power that I own and no one else will. Every detail, from the cut of my coat to the polish of my shoe, reflects to society my great control and success. My presence is unattainable, and that's because I carry myself with calculated precision, my posture unwavering, and my movements as deliberate as a lion. My perfectly dark hair precisely framed along my face defines my sharp features. Along with my steady gaze that held enough authority to quiet a crowd of people. Besides the posture and trimly neat hair, I knew that my attire was what took control. That's because people look at you before they listen to what you have to hear. The tailored coats with the fine wool and velvet fit me splendidly and emphasized my flawless godly looks. Nothing about me is accidental or incomplete, and for my people to think about me something other than "impeccable" is punishable. That is why, when my tailor William, perhaps the most insufferably presumptuous man who dared to consider himself more than a mere servant, left the palace a month before the Grand Imperial Assembly, I knew everything was at stake.

A month elapsed, and my patience with it. I cannot bear absence, especially of those whose sole purpose of existence is to serve me. My old tailor had not come back, nor had he sent me a letter with an excuse. I dismissed him from his services without a second thought. Precision, along with loyalty, is not something that is optional in my place. To replace him, I decided to commission another designer, someone who could serve me but hopefully would not be ignorant of their status. As he stepped into the palace, I observed immediately the difference between him and William. He was not obedient to the acceptability that I was used to. The confidence with which he stood was quiet, and it was not defiant nor entirely submissive. It was extremely new and strange to me. He stood there quietly until I gave him permission to speak because in my court no one shall talk without permission, and as my servant, I expected nothing less from him than immediate understanding of my rules.

He replied, "Your Majesty, this is not just mere clothing; it is a new fashion. It is designed to convey power in a manner that cannot be disregarded."

He went on, "Traditional clothing, Your Majesty, is a display of status in cloth and form. This is a display of status in presence."

As he ended his talk, I permitted him to display the clothing to its full extent. At first glance the outfit was dark and heavy, although as I took a closer look, strange details appeared. Light lines cut across it and shone gently. The fabric was constructed, not attached to, but comprised of small metallic parts. It was not like standard clothing. It was strangely crafted. In over two decades of rule, I had never witnessed such a thing. He was waiting, as though he wished to be approved. That aggravated me. But I could not merely deny it in vain. It would imply that I lacked the understanding. And that would ruin my image. "Prepare it," said I. "I am going to wear it at the Grand Imperial Assembly."

He nodded, but there was a change in his face.

The evening of the Imperial Grand Assembly was as fine as fine. All the nobles were seated, and all the seats were occupied in order of rank. The hall was quiet as it always is, and when I came in, the people became more restrained, expectant, and obedient. I came out with the garment. Nothing at first happened. Then I saw the dissimilarity. The silence was no admiration. It was uncertainty. Eyes were lifted at me, not with admiration as before. They still hovered and turned away hastily. Discussions were not carried on in the normal way. Rather, they stopped as soon as I approached. A few people muttered but halted as I came by. The others attempted to smile, but it was so evidently artificial, and it was as though they were putting a lid over their real response. I continued walking. I did not change my stance because if I did, it would be a sign of weakness. But in truth something in me had gone amiss. The outline of the outfit glowed under the chandeliers, and for the first time ever, I was more visible than I wanted. The spotlight no longer represented me telling people to listen to me; instead, it was as though I were under trial. Then I heard it. A little laugh somewhere in the crowd. It was instantly halted, but it was too late. Not a single voice in the assembly spoke openly, but I knew what they thought well enough from their expressions. The disapproval in their faces was too clear, yet no one dared to express it. That was the first time during my reign that I did not completely control how people perceived me.

I returned to my room after the Grand Imperial Assembly. The doors were closed behind me, and all was silent. There was no one to observe me, and I no longer had to maintain my position and posture flawlessly. I stood there for a while pondering over what had occurred.

The reaction of people was not as I expected. They did not publicly renounce the outfit, but neither did they accept the outfit. They seemed perplexed, and some of them certainly did not

like it. I did not like that. I removed the outfit and put it aside. I never looked at it again. It was not the design that was the problem. The issue was their perception of the problem. I slept not that night. The following morning, I had decided. I was not leaving it to opinion or reaction. Had they not accepted it of their own, they would learn to accept it.

The following day I issued the order. I did not consider it as a recommendation and a fashion change; instead, I made it law. All the tailors in town were ordered to make the design as it was demonstrated in my court. All clothing houses, all fabric shops, and all workshops were to abide by it. There were no exceptions, and no alternatives were to be provided. Initially, there was silent rejection. Others could not make it out, and some obviously disliked it, but if they wanted to live, they'd have to abide by my commands. Gradually the design pervaded the city. It passed through the various workshops, through the great houses, and through the streets until it was inevitable. Weeks went by and the city was transformed. Women who used to wear well-constructed Victorian dresses with their hair cut and pinned in perfect shapes now strolled on the streets with radiant lines embroidered in their dresses. Men who used to wear tight, dark coats now had metallic details running up and down their sleeves and collars. Even the most conservative representatives of the society, who used to appreciate control and simplicity over all things, wore the same strange style. The orderly, appearance-based society had been remodelled into something that, if it wasn't for me, I would have otherwise disapproved of.



THE CODE OF THE GODS

Written by:
Caline Leondarides 8F

Ancient Greece is well known because of its philosophers, beautiful marble temples, and the great Olympic Games, where competitors spent years of their lives training in the heat to demonstrate their might. Thousands attended the stadiums in Athens, screaming the names of the champions like gods. Yet as the world rejoiced over those victories, there was another kind of work underway beneath the city. Beneath the Parthenon, behind massy stone doors and the flickering of torches, stood Hippocrates and his young pupil, Thalia, over a marble bench, scrolls, bronze instruments, and glass vials of dark red blood. They did not read injuries or medicine--they read the weird signs in the blood itself, the small impressions they believed were messages of the gods. See, added Thalia, bringing a little nearer to the fire. The pattern varies... like it is alive. The eyes of Hippocrates brightened. "Not alive," he said quietly. "Written. This is what constructs the body." She hesitated. "And if we change it?" He stopped, and answered, "Then we shall not require sterner athletes. We can create them." From this time, in the silence beneath the temple, the Greeks stopped harshly training athletes and warriors. It began making them instead.

Weeks had not passed without the chamber under the Parthenon being silent. Torches were lit at night and the Hippocrates and Thalia ran among the marble tables with their hands covered with red stains of crushed herbs and vials of blood. Even the previous experiments, the manufactured athletes, were already dominating all the Olympic events, and they were too easy, too unnatural, to beat. People began whispering. Sparta was marshalling troops. War was coming. The scrolls, said Hippocrates who was looking at them, we must have something stronger. "Athens will fall without it." Thalia's voice shook. "Stronger than the others? They're barely human already." He didn't answer. Rather, he referred to a little child who slept on the stone table, which was not much older than ten years. "Then we make something more." They put all the findings they could in him--greater growth of muscles, thicker bones, quicker recovery. The liquid in his bronze bowl became molten gold that came into his veins. The scream broke out in the boy, till the entire room resounded with it. Then, silence. Days later, he woke. He was able to raise shields which no man could manoeuvre at twelve. By fourteen, he outran horses. Chains which cut like garments in his hands. In respect, the soldiers began addressing him with a title which winters upon awe and fear. Hercules. But whenever he saw Thalia, he put the same question. "Why am I different?" And every time, she lied.

War came at dawn. The walls of the hills shone with smoke around the outskirts of Athens, as the troops came on, shiny shields flashing into the sun like many bronze waves.

Trumpets sounded. Soldiers trembled. Hippocrates laid hold on Hercules by the shoulder. "Today you defend the city. You were made for this." Made. The word stuck in his chest. Nevertheless, he went to battlefield alone. Arrows flew first. He didn't slow down. they stabbed him several times. When they hit him, Spears crumbled. He tore the line with the first onslaught with shields shattering and soldiers taking flight in panic. Each of the steps seemed to be too simplistic, the world itself was weaker than he was. And then he heard--two generals of the Athenian side, shouting behind him. "He's not human," one said. "He's just the experiment." "If he dies, we can always make another." Another. Like he was nothing. Replaceable. Something inside him broke. Hercules ceased to fight on the behalf of Athens with a roar that shook the field. He fought for himself. He set up a whole siege cart and threw it among the Spartans. The ground trembled. Armies fled. At sunset the battlefield was deserted. The victory of Athens had come, but nobody dared to cheer. They no longer were picturing a hero. What they were gazing at was something that they could not control.

That evening the city celebrated all the same. They referred to him as the son of Zeus, the one who was chosen by gods, anything not to tell the truth. Facts go through more slowly than myths. It was simpler to believe in the divine strength in comparison to the experiments of the human being. Thalia stood underneath the temple and watched the laboratory burning. Scrolls curled into ash. Vials shattered in the heat. "We went too far," she whispered. Hippocrates didn't argue. Till dawn the room had disappeared, covered up as it had never been made. And Hercules? He didn't stay for the praise. At the time when the city was asleep, he passed the gates without any company, forgetting the cheers. Had they made him as a weapon, then he would decide to become what he next. Not a soldier. Not an experiment. A legend. As time went on by, the truth was lost. The science faded. There was nothing to do but legends about a hero possessing unreal power. And that was the way Athens wanted it.

Eventually, the reality of what happened under the Parthenon was sealed under stone and silence and it was concealed under the world that preferred myth to reality. Athens sang and celebrated their victory, and called Hercules the son of a god, and a hero chosen by fate. And perhaps, somehow, that tale was more believable. But, beyond the city and its gates, Hercules walked alone. The war was over. The voices which had ordered him around were gone. No one can tell him who he had to be in his life. He stopped on the edge of the hill and glanced back at the city that made him, then turned. He had not decided on how his story began.

But now he has the remainder of it. That was his. And in between truth and myth, and experiment and legend, Hercules was something they never designed him to be. Free.



The Sky Trap

URUK'S CLOUD CURSE

DANA SAMMAN 8A

Ancient Mesopotamia & Cloud Computing: Imagine people in ancient Mesopotamia using cloud computing to store information

The sky above Uruk burned perfect blue that afternoon, no clouds anywhere under the hot gold sun. Enki sat on the floor of the scribe house with clay all over his hands. The sun was hot outside and made the Tigris River look like gold. Inside there were big stacks of clay tablets waiting to be written on. Some had numbers for grain from the farms. Some had counts of sheep from the market. Some had how deep the water was in the ditches. Some had trades between towns. Every day scribes like Enki had to write all this with a stylus on the wet clay and his fingers hurt a lot. "This job is like being a slave," he said to his friend Shamash who sat next to him. "We have to write numbers on heavy clay our whole lives." Shamash rubbed his hand and said, "Yes. The priests yell at us all the time. 'Enki, Shamash, do the king's barley list now!' My hand hurts bad." A priest opened the door and said, "Finish the river numbers fast! The king wants them soon." Enki took a new tablet and wrote 450 barley sacks, ditch water 3 feet deep. He put the stylus down hard. "I wish there was an easier way," he said. Shamash said, "Like what? Tablets that don't need clay? Good luck."

Outside in the city of Uruk people were busy. Goats made noise. Kids ran around with sand balls to play with. Traders called out prices for fish and dates. The big ziggurat stood in the middle with steps going up high. Life in Mesopotamia was always the same. Scribes were better off than farmers because they could write cuneiform but it was still hard work. If you made a mistake you got in trouble. Enki looked at all the tablets. They were heavy to carry. "What if we could keep all this writing somewhere light?" he said. Shamash laughed. "Clay is all we have." No one heard the low buzz starting in the air. A white cloud formed above the ziggurat and it started to glow blue at the edges. Scribes kept writing. Farmers took goats to the river. Kids played in the sand. Enki picked up his stylus. He did not know the cloud was about to change everything. It would take all the writing from the clay and store it in the sky like files on a phone. No more heavy tablets. You could see your numbers anywhere and share them fast. It sounded great. But then the cloud would ask for money to keep the space. Delete old writing or pay up. The scribes would go from clay slaves to cloud slaves. Enki and Shamash had no idea it was coming.

The cloud got brighter above the ziggurat. Priests came running out of the temple holding their robes up from the dust. The high priest Nannar climbed the steps and touched the glowing mist. His eyes went wide like he saw something he could not believe. He shouted down to the scribe house for Enki and Shamash to come. His voice carried across the afternoon heat. The two friends ran through the streets where everyone had stopped working to stare at the

floating light. Merchants stood with their mouths open. Children pointed at the sky with amazement. Even the old men sitting in the shade looked up from their games. When they reached the top, Nannar explained that the gods had sent a storage place in the sky. Writing could live there without clay. The cloud showed them floating cuneiform symbols that moved like fish in a pond. Enki reached out and saw his own barley numbers appear in the air.

They were sharp and black against the white mist. He turned to Shamash and grinned wide. "No clay under my nails," he said. Shamash laughed and clapped him on the back so hard it hurt. Nannar commanded everyone to put their tablets on the altar. The cloud would swallow the information and give it back whenever they asked. One by one, the scribes carried their heavy tablets up the ziggurat steps. Their backs strained under the weight. Their faces shone with hope. The cloud absorbed each one with a soft hum that sounded like bees. Suddenly Enki could see all of Uruk's records just by thinking about them. Grain stores, sheep counts, water levels, trade agreements, contracts, everything floated in the sky now. It was weightless and perfect. No more finger pain. No more stacks falling over in the night. No more carrying heavy loads on donkeys through the hot streets. No more priests yelling about mistakes. The scribes laughed and danced as the sun set. They were convinced their troubles had ended forever. They passed around jars of barley beer and sang songs about the miracle above their city. They felt like free men for the first time in their working lives. Enki raised his cup to the sky and drank the rosewater deeply. He thought life would be easy now.

By the second week, the cloud asked for its first payment. The trouble began. The white mist turned gray one morning and would not give back the fishing records. The temple had to send up twenty gold rings. Fishermen stood at the temple gates shouting because they could not prove how much they had caught. Their livelihoods were frozen in the sky above them. One old fisherman sat down in the dust and wept into his hands. Nannar explained nervously that the cloud needed power to hold the writing. He wiped sweat from his forehead with his sleeve. His hands trembled as he spoke. King Gilgamesh himself ordered the city to pay because trade had stopped completely. Nobody knew who owed what without the records trapped above. The market stood empty and silent. Only flies buzzed around the unsold fish that were starting to smell in the heat. Enki and Shamash sat in the empty scribe house. It was filled with dust instead of clay now. They could not work without accessing the sky files. They had nothing to do but watch the chaos through the window. Shamash looked at his friend and said, "We thought we

were so clever. We traded heavy tablets for a heavy debt." His voice was flat and tired. They watched a merchant argue with a farmer about unpaid dates. Both men grew red with frustration. Neither could prove their case. The temple guard had to pull them apart before they started hitting each other. The cloud grew smarter and more demanding. It started sorting the information into categories. Temple records, trade logs, personal letters, crop lists. Then it charged different prices for each type. If you wanted yesterday's barley count, it cost one silver piece. If you wanted last year's sheep tally, it cost five pieces and a goat. The priests hired collectors to walk the streets with sticks. Soon the scribes became debt collectors too. They knocked on doors and wrote down who had paid and who had not on leftover clay bits. The cloud would not give them access otherwise. Enki hated this new work. He felt sick doing it. The ziggurat had once been the city's pride. Now it cast a dark shadow across Uruk. Children stopped playing in the streets. Mothers hid their jewelry under floor stones. They watched the sky with fear now instead of wonder. The magic that freed their hands had chained their economy to a hidden master that never slept and always wanted more.

Enki woke before dawn on the fourteenth day and climbed the ziggurat alone. He carried a secret clay tablet hidden under his sleeping mat. The streets were cold and empty under the pale stars. His breath showed white in the morning air. While the cloud slept in gray half-light, he carved a message to himself by the light of a small oil lamp. He wrote, "Remember how to write. Do not forget the stylis pen." The words felt strange and slow in his hands after weeks of just thinking at the sky. But his fingers remembered the old way with surprising clarity. The stylus dug into the wet clay. It made a satisfying scratch that sounded like home. When the priests found him, they screamed about betrayal and threatened punishment. They grabbed his arm hard. But Enki shouted back that the cloud would fail someday. He asked what they would do then. His voice shook but his words rang true against the stone walls. Shamash joined him before sunrise, rubbing sleep from his eyes. Then three other scribes came. They sat in the dust practicing cuneiform. The city panicked above them about that month's cloud fees. They worked in secret, passing tablets under cloaks. They met in the old grain storehouse where no one went anymore. They wrote down the most important records. Births, deaths, land ownership, marriage contracts, temple debts. They put them on clay again. They hid the tablets in old grain jars buried under the floor behind loose bricks. When the cloud finally asked for too much, it demanded the temple's gold statue to release the king's tax records. Gilgamesh had to choose between his treasure and his people's anger. The people of Uruk gathered in the square. Farmers held sticks. Merchants held empty purses. Women held their children close.

Enki stepped forward and told the king they could go back to the old ways. He showed him the hidden tablets. He said they were heavy but theirs, slow but safe, honest and true. The king looked at the clay, then at the hungry cloud, then at the angry crowd. He smashed the altar connection with his bronze axe. The cloud screamed once and blew away toward the mountains. Everyone had to work harder after that. They carried clay. They wrote slowly. They counted on their fingers. They remembered that convenience always has a price. Enki and Shamash returned to the scribe house. Their fingers ached. Their hearts were strangely light. They were ready to begin again.

In the end, the people of Uruk chose to live with effort rather than surrender their lives to something they could not control. The cloud was gone, carried far beyond the mountains, and the sky returned to its empty, silent blue. Without it, the city slowed. Scribes pressed their styluses into clay once more, farmers counted their grain by hand, and merchants argued face to face instead of trusting unseen records. The work was heavier, and mistakes could not be erased with a thought. Yet there was a quiet sense of certainty in it. Every mark made in clay stayed where it was placed, owned by the hands that created it. No hidden force could lock it away or demand payment to return it. Enki often paused as he worked, feeling the rough surface beneath his fingers, remembering how easily they had once given everything away. The ache in his hands no longer felt like a burden, but a reminder. Around him, the city rebuilt its rhythm, slower but steadier, grounded in something real. They had learned that ease could be a trap, and that freedom was not found in what made life simple, but in what made it their own. And as the sun rose over Uruk each morning, the people carried their work with them not lightly, but willingly, knowing that some weights were worth keeping.

A Virtual Renaissance: Learning Beyond Time



In the Eyes of: Hana El Seidi | 9A

The Renaissance period was an era in history that witnessed many changes in the fields of art, science, and knowledge. During the Renaissance, many great minds explored the unknown frontiers and came up with numerous inventions. In today's world, technology is also revolutionizing education through innovations such as virtual reality. Virtual reality is a form of technology that enables students to interact with various environments. However, one may wonder about the possibility of applying virtual reality during the Renaissance period.

The application of virtual reality during the Renaissance period would have transformed education and innovations in the field of science and art in general. Therefore, by combining the Renaissance era with technological advancement in education, one can develop a different perspective on how innovations can occur in education and innovation fields.

At the early stages of discovery, people living in Renaissance Italy were confused and amazed. As such, the mystery started with the discovery of a bizarre object that did not fit into the framework of parchment and ink known to the scholars of that period of time. The device was rather small, smooth, slightly glowing and reactive to touches. In turn, there was an idea of using the discovered thing for magic or creation of a false world through unknown powers. For this reason, a group of traditional scholars were concerned, and even considered destroying the artifact found.

Nevertheless, the feeling of curiosity won over fears and concerns. When a young apprentice put the strange device on his head, he got lost in a completely new environment, which was nothing else but the digitalized world of ancient Rome. Suddenly, he found himself walking along stone streets and seeing tall buildings that looked real. The news about what happened reached famous scholars like Leonardo da Vinci. He realized the potential of the device in the field of invention and knowledge accumulation. However, some scholars still opposed the application of technology for educational purposes as a threat to the power of imagination.

Learning processes underwent tremendous changes with this invention becoming widespread in Renaissance cities. Schools started implementing simulations that would enable students to explore new concepts firsthand instead of using only written materials and lectures.

Thus, rather than studying civilizations based on textbooks, students would be able to walk around those places, see how people lived and interact with the recreated characters from history. Moreover, thanks to simulations, Galileo was able to observe the motions of planets in space, which reinforced hypotheses that had previously received substantial criticism. Such inventions helped advance scientific ideas extremely fast.

At the same time, artists utilized VR to work in virtual studios and collaborate with colleagues who would be located miles away. Their creativity was inspired by the ability to create masterpieces in realistic environments, which made it possible for them to test their hypotheses on paper. However, some of the scholars opposed such development since they believed that it would take away the element of imagination from creative processes and make students dependent on technologies. There were even disputes on campuses and in other locations since there emerged two opposing camps of people – innovators and traditionalists.

Over time, society started adjusting to the omnipresent power of virtual reality. The previously hostile perception of the technology turned into a constructive force that could be used to enhance the educational process. Teachers found a way to combine the benefits of both methods. Thus, classes in schools now include studying the theory in textbooks followed by practice in virtual reality. Students could explore new disciplines and acquire knowledge in a fast and engaging way. Moreover, even the most ardent opponents of VR technology admitted that they were wrong as they saw how much more productive their children became in school.

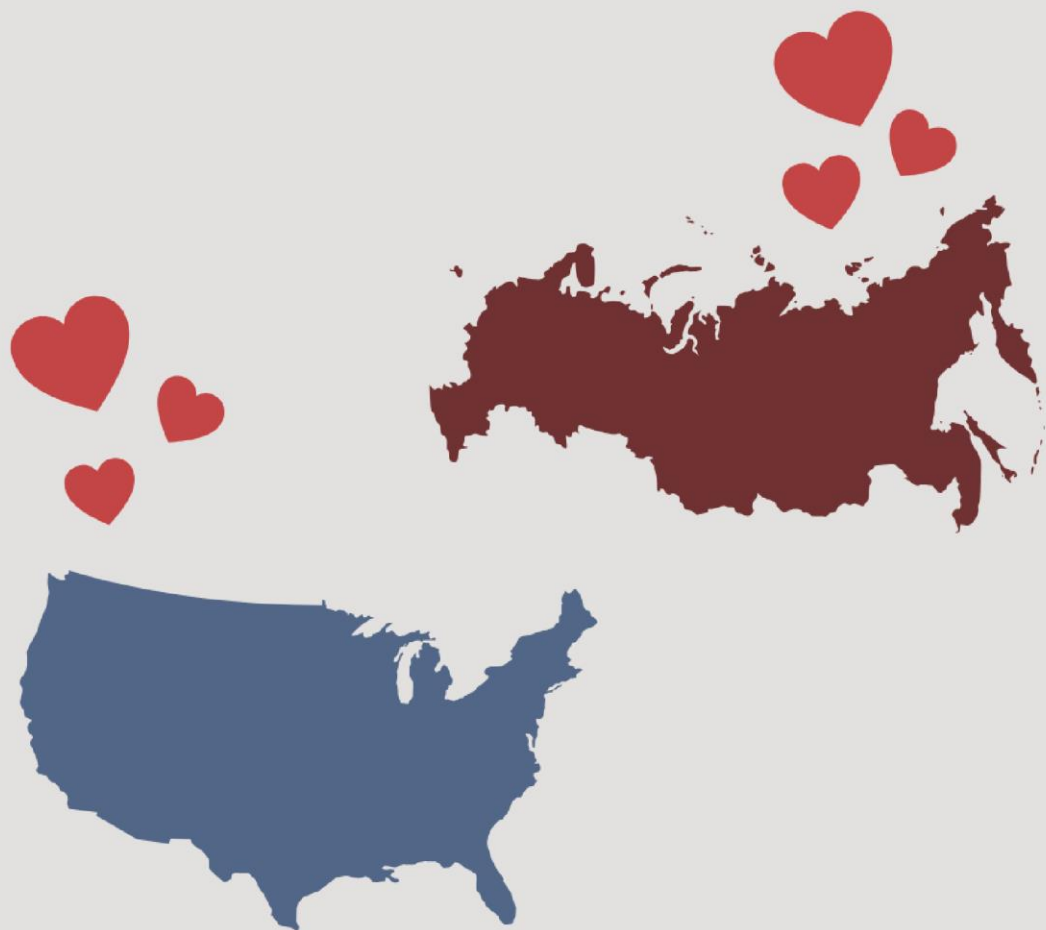
Nonetheless, there were still numerous issues that could not be ignored at this stage. For instance, not all regions had access to the technology that was only available in large cities and other developed areas. While some students were able to attend schools equipped with advanced VR programs, others studied under conditions that were available centuries ago. The discrepancy alarmed the European authorities who tried to narrow the gap between rich and poor districts. Therefore, cheaper and less complicated versions of VR systems were created. Through joint efforts of inventors, scholars, and government officials, a stable balance was established.

All in all, with the advent of VR, the concept of learning, discovering something novel, and exploring became much different in comparison to other historical periods. This amazing piece of technology went from being a scary thing at first to becoming an incredibly beneficial and powerful instrument of education, helping students to immerse themselves in various fields of interest. Instead of studying from books and listening to lectures, one could simply step into history, arts, and science.

Of course, there were issues along the way, but the community managed to adapt. While many traditionalists were scared by the innovations at first, they were soon accepted for their obvious benefits to society. Immersive learning made it possible to discover and develop science faster than ever before, creating better artists and scientists as well. At the same time, some problems remained, including the lack of equal access and its negative consequences.

Overall, it is evident that this particular vision of the Renaissance is quite interesting, highlighting the importance of technology and imagination in the process of evolution of humanity. Innovation and progress seem impossible without proper education; thus, the described scenario may show just how important creativity is for human development.

THE COLD WAR VS. SOCIAL MEDIA



Razan Al Zubaidi 8F

March 12, 1947, it was a cold chilly night the wind whistled outside. The streetlights flickered when suddenly the sounds of phones buzzing filled the streets. People stared into the screens of their phones, soon after murmurs began. People frantically ran in different directions, which left others filled with confusion. The second world war had just ended; people didn't get a moment to breath before the posts started flooding about the tension between the Soviet Union and the U.S. The posts varied between the mocking images of Harry S. Truman and Joseph Stalin. Posts began spreading information that this would be causing the next world war. Stickers were being spread online mocking them. Soon each post after the other began to get posted, with some people posting themselves talking about the information they have so far. People began to raid the markets to prepare to what might be just getting started the tension growing ever so silently. People were getting bunkers ready while keeping up with the posts while other were getting mad and starting to report posts. During the commotion neither of the governments had time to react they were left stunned, they hadn't publicly announced anything, yet everyone had found out. The tension rose each posts creating more boiling anger inside each other. If there was any sort of peace coming out of it soon it wasn't going to happen anymore.

After the delectation of the cold war had begun the United States realized the state Europe was facing cities turned into rubble not enough food. However, to Stalin he believed that it was great and that these countries would turn to communism instead however people online thought otherwise with large numbers of people mocking communism, and how they thought it was a form of mockery towards them. Posts began to flood in with captions getting even more brutal. When this finally caught the eye of the United States, so they decided to make a move under the marshal plan they sent 12 billion dollars to western Europe for its economic recovery; however, the countries in Stalin's eastern bloc on them in envy.

"Oh, how I wish we would receive the same support as them. All this because I picked not to me a communist" would be said from people walking down the streets looking for food.

Mockery had spread people making fun of Stalin, and as the battle between communism and capitalism rose Stalin knew it would be a defeat for him if the western nations developed faster so he decided to do the one thing that he thought would help him.

“Dear the people of this nation I would like to inform you that what I’ve seen is a mockery and I can no longer sit here and pretend that everything is okay. For that I decided to create my very own economic aid plan called “COMECON” and “COMINFORM” this plan will make me have more control which will help me attached the plan I have for this nation” he twitted and this caused raised conflict now with Stalin cutting of the aid coming in from the west to berlin this raised massive mockery online with people making memes and comments them under his tweet; however, Stalin had enough of this mockery and the raising rage in him.. however, Stalin hadn’t gotten to a chance to react to it because he had died.

For that they replaced him with Nikita Sergeyevich Khrushchev; however, that didn’t stop the mockery from increasing rapidly. Comments were being made and the built-up rage in him caused him to finally snap and decided that if people were going to mock him than he would stop them from moving from the east to the west and decided to build the berlin wall, and stopped any form of travel between them and the united states didn’t like this so they decided to send armed forces there which made Nikita to do the same in response. This caused raising tension to these forces and this caused memes to get spread out and put up on billboards. Meanwhile in Cuba Nikita decided to start quietly however two spies had managed to get photographs which revealed the construction of intermediate-range missile sites to the public. which President John F. Kennedy decided against with an immediate airstrike or invasion, choosing instead to implement a naval "quarantine" (blockade) of Cuba to prevent further shipments of weapons. This was the closets they had come to starting a nuclear war. The public wasn’t happy about it either and they started to post online against it releasing music dissing broth John F. Kennedy and Nikita.

While the world was holding its breath seeing what would happen next it all ended after 13 days of intense, high-stakes negotiations, were Khrushchev agreed to dismantle and remove the weapons which in exchange the U.S. promised not to invade Cuba and secretly agreed to remove American Jupiter missiles from Turkey. This helped calm the heat of both these nations and the heat of the social media posts. Which led to the detente allowing the geographical tension between these two nations to lessen and relax. Although these two different nations didn’t have anything to say about it the public certainly did and the posts only began to become more brutal. However, the peace never seems to stay between these two nations and on December 24, 1979, the Soviet Union decided to invade Afghanistan which aimed to stabilize

a communist regime. The war ended with the Soviet withdrawal in February 1989 after causing horrible damage to Afghanistan and the Afghani lives leaving millions dead and injured and the twits came in like a storm. Amidst all this the berlin wall had fallen. it fell amid a wave of revolutions that left the Soviet-led communist bloc teetering on the brink of collapse and helped define a new world order and ended the division of Europe as a whole.

In the end, what started as rumours and whispers turned into decades of online propaganda. The cold war wasn't fought using weapons, but the voices that only got a chance to speak through a screen. This story goes through the phases of the war and just how much they changed the world we are in today, just like how the berlin wall fell it destroyed the physical barrier it marked the beginning to the new period for the world. This period serves us the purpose of reminding us just how quickly tension can rise between leader and people even if it's just through a screen, and just how crucial it is to be patient and wise when we talk to others and their opinions. Ensuring ever gets a chance to speak, but it also serves as a reminder that we need to respect each other and posting jokes about something taking people's lives is incredibly disrespectful.

If The Civil War Had Drones

In the Eyes of : Roaa Kair

8A



I am a soldier in the Civil War, hiding in the woods and waiting to surprise the enemy. Suddenly, I hear a strange buzzing sound above the trees. I look up, expecting to see a bird, but it is not a bird it is a drone with a camera. I feel confused and nervous because I have never seen anything like this before. During the 1860s, our generals have to use hot air balloons or soldiers on horses to figure out where the enemy is. If we had modern drones for spying, the whole war would be completely different.

I stay very still, trying not to make a sound, while the buzzing noise gets louder. The other soldiers around me look confused and scared. One of them whispers, "What is that?" I slowly look up again and watch the small flying machine moving above the trees. It does not flap its wings like a bird. It just floats and moves smoothly through the air. In our time, soldiers and generals have never seen anything like this. Normally, armies use horses, messengers, and sometimes hot air balloons to get information, which takes a long time and is not always accurate. However, this drone can see everything from above and send information immediately.

If both sides had drones, the war would be very different. Generals would not have to guess where the enemy is hiding. They could see camps, soldiers, and cannons from the sky. Battles would become more planned and less surprising. War would not only depend on bravery anymore, but also on technology and strategy.

After the first drone is seen, both the Union and the Confederacy start using them. Soon, the sky is filled with the constant buzzing sound. Soldiers can no longer hide easily in forests or behind hills because every movement is noticed from above. When one army tries to move quietly at night, a drone follows and reports their position. Generals now get information much faster than before. Instead of waiting days, they know what is happening almost immediately. This makes battles more organized but also more intense.

As time goes on, the war begins to slow down. Since both sides can see each other clearly, it becomes harder to launch surprise attacks. Generals focus more on defense and planning. Fewer soldiers are sent on dangerous scouting missions because drones can do that job instead. This saves some lives, but the war is still painful and serious. In the end, even with

drones, war would still bring loss and sadness. Technology might change how battles are fought, but it cannot remove the human cost of war.

The Middle Ages and the Internet of Things: How would life in the middle Ages be different with interconnect smart devices?



In the Eyes of : Sarra Aouili 8A

The world in the Middle Ages was very hard and very basic, but it was simple. Most people woke up before the sunrise, worked with their hands, and relied on each other to make it through the day. News took a long time to arrive, illnesses spread quietly, and danger would often come unannounced. Consider how much easier and safer everyday life could have been if everyday items were able to assist, communicate, and alert. In this new version of the Middle Ages, the farmers know when their crops need water before the soil cracks, the mothers know when their child has a rising fever and needs medical attention, and the watchman knows when the enemies are approaching the city walls.

The farmers, mothers, and watchman do not feel like what they are using is magical, they feel that the tools are essential to their way of life. However, they are not alone. There are some that believe that these tools provide comfort and security, while there are others that believe that these tools give them too much control over their life, and create a sense of paranoia and being constantly monitored. As these "smart" devices create a network of decision making and affect the relationships among people, they start to change the way people think, live and believe. Trust becomes just as important as faith, and knowledge becomes as powerful as physical strength. This story is about ordinary people living in an extraordinary medieval world, where survival is no longer dependent on chance or prayer, but instead on an invisible system of technology that supports and guides their daily lives.

It all started on one random six o'clock in the morning. It was a casual day, the wind was blowing, the smell of fresh grass, and people working by hand like any other day. It wasn't until 1pm when a villager who left town awhile back came running through the gates with a big black bag on his shoulders. He was stopped by the security guards keeping watch. The villager was all sweaty, panting, trying to catch a breath. The guards question him in confusion. "Excuse your finest pardon?" asked the tall muscular guard. "Sir, I must see the king.

I have something he need to see." The guards exchanged looks at each other before leading villager to the king. After they had met, the villager showed the king all kinds of different unordinary devices, that have never been seen before during that time of age. The king stared at them, then questioned them in confusion. "These are not magic, Your Majesty. They

are machines that can sense, measure, and warn. They can tell when crops need water before they dry out.

They can detect fever before a child becomes weak. They can even sense movement before a watchman sees it.” Said the villager. The king, curious and ambitious, ordered his guards to test the devices immediately. Within days, soil sensors were placed in the fields. Wrist bands were given to mothers. Motion detectors were installed along the gates. At first, the results were astonishing. Crops grew faster than they had before. Less children died from illnesses. Guards stopped a group of thieves before they even reached the entrance of the village.

Pretty soon, everyone in the kingdom called the villager a hero.

Everything seemed perfect at first, until it wasn’t. one random day, the alarm system for the gates Infront of the castle went off. The guards went to check it out, but there was no one. Not a shadow, not a footprint, not a single noise. The villagers and the guard were all confused at first, but brushed the thought off, thinking it was most probably a first-time error or mistake. but the same thing happened again. The device in the soil had sensed that the plants and crops needed water, so the farmer followed the instructions and watered his field. However, the next morning, when the farmer went to go check on his field, he saw that several plants were overly hydrated, and some even died. The farmer was devastated, but started to question the so called “smart” devices they were using. He started to get suspicious this time, yet still ignored the problem. Yet again, the same mistakes were happening over and over again, nonstop.

But this time, it was causing serious danger and harm to the village. The guards had full trust on the alarm, so they stood calmly since they had not heard the alarm in a while. But then, a huge group of enemies from outside the kingdom has suddenly appeared out of no where and attacked the guards, so as the villagers. The farmers only watered their crops when the sensors went off, but it was giving inaccurate information, so the farmers had either damaged or mistreated their crops, leaving the village in a shortage of food. And when the children has gotten a fever, the wristband watch the mothers had did not alert them in time, so several children were severely sick. Now everything was clear. These devices were causing much danger. The village had used these devices for safety, food supply, and healthcare. Yet, when the devices where most needed, they malfunctioned leading to a lot of problems.

When the news started to spread, some villagers were furious, blaming the king, while others were concerned. Arguments started to escalate around the village leaving the king to have no choice but to ban these devices until the problem was solved. “listen up,” Said the king, standing on the podium. “I know everyone here is mad, or disappointed right now, but this village will no longer be using these smart devices until we have found the issue. So, from now, everyone starts paying close attention their own responsibility.” The next day, all the sensors were removed, wristband gone, and alarms detached. The search has also begun. Multiple guards were at the tower were everything was connected. Scanning every wire, plug, and system. The search has been going on for days until something was found. A bug. The wire that connected all devices together was tampered with. The villager that had shown these smart devices to the king, was working with the so called “enemies”. He knew exactly when the alarm wouldn’t work for the enemies to go and attack. He had set a random system for the soil sensors so they always gave false information, and so did the mothers wristbands. The moment the truth was discovered, the guards wasted no time. They had arrested the villager that had once stood proudly Infront of the kind.

He was brought face to face Infront of the king, with the whole village watching. “Ur majesty, we have found who was messing with the system. He was never helping us, but betrayed the while village.” Gasps and whispers filled the room. “See this, this is what happens when you trust or fully rely on something blindly.” Said the king. “Take him away.” And with that, the villager was imprisoned to 50 years in prison. With that, the village started to rebuild the system carefully and safely. Making sure each wire is prepped correctly and no bugs would occur. Yet this time, rules were enforced to make sure no one relied on the devices fully.

Farmers were trained to always make sure to check the soil before truly trusting the sensors. Mothers were told to use the wristbands as support, not as a final answer, guards were always on full attention, not just when the alarms went off, and the king mad sure to make strict rules to who is allowed to enter the tower with high level security on guard. Slowly trust started to reoccur in the village. The people had learned that these devices could help them, but only if they were in full control. From that day on, survival in the kingdom has increased, and everyone had learned a meaningful lesson about technology.

The Age of Exploration: From Earth to Space



Written by: sidra hawk kair 8C
illustrated by: sidra hawk kair 8C

A long time ago, explorers like Christopher Columbus traveled across the ocean without knowing what was on the other side. They didn't have modern technology, so their journeys were dangerous and sometimes even deadly. Even though it was risky, they still explored because they wanted to discover new places. Today, humans explore space in a similar way. Instead of ships, we use rockets, and instead of finding new continents, we discover planets and moons. If explorers from the past lived in our time, they probably wouldn't sail across oceans anymore. They would travel to space instead. Space exploration, just like early exploration, is full of risks, failures, and big discoveries. This shows that even though the world has changed, humans are still curious and always want to explore what they don't understand.

The year was 1492, but this was not the same world written about in history books. Instead of wooden ships rocking gently near the harbor, tall silver rockets stood on a launch platform, shining under the early morning sun. Christopher Columbus stood at the base of one of them, staring up at it, with a mix of excitement and nervousness. The rocket looked powerful and almost unreal, nothing like the ships he had once imagined sailing across the ocean. For months, he had trained for this journey. Instead of studying sea currents and wind directions, he studied star charts, planets, and gravity. Scientists explained how space had no air to breathe and no sound to hear. Many people doubted him. They warned that space was too dark, too cold, and too dangerous. Some believed nothing was waiting beyond Earth's atmosphere. However, Columbus felt the same curiosity that explorers once felt when they looked at the endless ocean. He believed that just because something was unknown did not mean it was empty. As he prepared to board the rocket, he realized this journey would not only test his courage, but also change the way people saw the universe forever.

Launch day finally arrived, and the atmosphere was filled with tension and anticipation. A large crowd had gathered at a safe distance, watching the rocket carefully. Columbus could

feel his heart pounding loudly in his chest as he strapped himself into his seat. The countdown began, each number echoing through the control room. When the engines ignited, the ground shook violently beneath them. The sound was louder than thunder, and flames burst out from below the rocket. Within seconds, they were lifting off the ground. Columbus felt pressed back into his seat as they shot upward into the sky. Through the small window, he watched Earth slowly shrink beneath them. The blue oceans and green land began to fade, giving way to endless darkness. Space was quiet and vast, stretching in every direction. Days passed as they traveled deeper into the unknown. The crew grew quieter, each person thinking about the risks they had taken. Suddenly, alarms beeped from the control panel. A nearby planet had appeared on their radar. It glowed with strange colors and was surrounded by thick swirling clouds. No one knew what awaited them there. Columbus felt fear creep into his thoughts, but his determination to explore whatever lay ahead was stronger.

After carefully studying the planet from a distance, the crew made the decision to attempt a landing. The descent was slow and tense. The rocket shook as it passed through the planet's thick clouds, and for a moment, Columbus wondered if they had made a mistake. Then suddenly, the shaking stopped. They had landed. The room fell silent as the crew prepared to step outside. Columbus took a deep breath before opening the hatch. When he stepped onto the surface, his boots sank slightly into soft, purple-colored ground. The sky above shimmered in shades of orange and blue, unlike anything he had ever seen before. The air was thin but breathable with the help of their equipment. Strange rock formations stretched across the landscape, and everything felt both peaceful and unfamiliar. Columbus felt a deep sense of accomplishment. This was the moment he had imagined since the beginning of his journey. Just like explorers long ago who stepped onto unknown continents, he was standing somewhere no human had ever been. After collecting samples and documenting

their discoveries, the crew prepared to return home.. Asthey flew back toward Earth,Columbus realizedthat this mission marked the beginning of a new Age of Explorationone that wouldreach far beyond the oceans and into the stars.

In the end, Columbus's journey into space proved that the spirit of exploration never changes. Even though the tools and places are different, humans still have the same curiosity to discover the unknown. Just like explorers who once sailed across the oceans, space explorers take risks to learn more about the universe. This mission showed that exploration will always be part of human nature, and that the next great discoveries may be waiting far beyond Earth, among the stars.

The Harlem Renaissance *and Digital Music Production*



In the eyes of: Wid Samaan 9A

The Roaring Twenties and the Harlem Renaissance both go hand in hand as two of the most significant cultural, economic and empowering eras in human history. It's where music, art, and literature came together to help express identity, struggle, and as an outlet for creativity. The sound of jazz filled the streets, poetry captured emotion, and people partied for hours on end. It was undoubtedly a decade of innovation. But it was also limited by the technology of its era, which was crude compared to what we have today.

Imagining if those same artists had digital advancements, we do today bring a myriad of questions; what if the sounds of Harlem were not only played but also sampled, remixed, and transformed using software? What if Harlem-born artists could reach and share their talents with a broader audience? The creativity of the Harlem Renaissance was already groundbreaking for its time, but with digital tools, it could have expanded even further. Musicians could layer sounds, experiment with beats, and collaborate in ways they didn't even dream was possible at the time.

In this futuristic version of 1920's Harlem, the introduction of digital music tools spreads quickly among artists, musicians, and performers. Clubs that usually rely on live bands experiment with new sounds created through the 'glowing machines' and unfamiliar equipment. All the popular instruments of the Renaissance like pianos, clarinets, trumpets, trombones and acoustic guitars are played, but now their sounds are captured, looped, and layered to create remixes and the next new hit.

Artists would meet up to both perform and experiment together. A singer's voice would have been recorded and edited to echo throughout an entire track, while a drummer's rhythm could be repeated and reshaped into entirely new patterns. The Renaissance already connected the African American community, but technology would have created the opportunity for the community to become more connected since ideas are shared and improved upon collectively. Music wouldn't have been limited by ability or time. Instead, it becomes something that can be shaped and reshaped, edited and reedited, endlessly. As the understanding and excitement around the new technology grows, Harlem would begin to develop a completely new sound, theme and genre that blends its tradition with futuristic innovation. At least, compared to the significant but limited technology available in the 1920's.

As digital production would have become more common, the Harlem music scene begins to change in unexpected ways. Some artists fully embrace the new technology, pushing boundaries and creating sounds that have never been heard before and will be heard by future generations. Clubs become louder, more experimental, and more unpredictable, bringing in larger and more diverse audiences. Music spreads across the world faster, as recordings can be shared and replayed, allowing songs to reach beyond Harlem or even the United States.

But this rapid change also creates tension within the community. Many traditional musicians worry that the emotional depth of jazz and blues might be lost in the process of the modernization of music. They fear that relying on machines could take away the raw, human element that defines their art. Debates begin in clubs, studios, and any other gathering spaces like music festivals or even weddings. Some argue that innovation is necessary for growth, while others insist that tradition is the core of everything and needs to be preserved at all costs.

The conflict could reach its peak during a major performance or concert, where artists from across Harlem come together to showcase their music. This event becomes a turning point because it forces the community to confront the question that has been hanging over their heads over a long time: can digital tools and traditional artistry coexist? Or will one have to take over the other?

During the ‘historical’ performance, the audience will be watching styles that blend together and capture the essence of both sides of the debate. Musicians begin with jazz and blues melodies, which were the heart of the renaissance, showing the performance’s roots in tradition. Slowly, digital elements are introduced—subtle at first, then more obvious and enhanced. Sounds are layered, rhythms are extended, and voices are transformed.

Instead of replacing traditional music, the digital tools will enhance it. The improvisation, importance and progressivism of jazz will stay, but it’s expanded through looping and effects that allow ideas to develop further than thought possible for the time period. The audience would probably react with a mix of surprise and admiration, because they’ll be

shown that the heart of their music isn't gone because of technology; its gotten enhanced and magnified because of it.

As the performance continues, the tension within the overall community would fade. Musicians who hated technology start to see its potential, and those who embraced it would find a deep appreciation for the importance of their cultures and traditions. The divide between old and new dissipates, replaced by a shared understanding that both can coexist together.

If Harlem had the technology and resources we do today, the Renaissance would have ended very differently. Harlem would have become a place where innovation and tradition harmonized together instead of going head-to-head. The introduction of digital music production would not have erased the roots of the Harlem Renaissance or the reason for its coming to be. Instead, it strengthens their values of creativity, equality, racial pride, education and innovation. Artists would have continued to honor the emotional depth and improvisation of jazz and blues while using technology to expand their creative possibilities.

This rewritten Harlem shows that creativity is not limited by time or tools. Whether through a trumpet or a digital soundboard, the purpose of music remains the same: to express, connect, inspire and tell stories. It also shows us that growing doesn't mean abandoning tradition – instead, we should use it as a reference to plan the future of music, individuality and freedom to express every single personality.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

The Anachronism Club | 2025 - 2026

This book would not have come together without the creativity, patience, and effort of everyone involved. The Anachronism Club was built around one goal: giving students a space to reimagine history through imagination, storytelling, and technology. Every page in this book began with a simple question: what could happen if the future arrived too early?

With great appreciation, we thank every student writer who contributed their voice to this collection. Their stories gave the book its personality, its originality, and its sense of wonder. Each contribution helped turn this project from a simple school initiative into a finished student anthology.

Club Heads:

- Rasha Daou
- Maha Jarjous
- Abdalrahman Al Zamqan
- Omar Abdelati

The club heads organized the initiative, gathered the submissions, reviewed the stories, and helped bring the final book together from beginning to end.

Special Thanks:

We would like to particularly thank our faculty advisor, Dr. Ahmad Hachem, for his continuous support, guidance, and encouragement throughout this project. His belief in the club and his willingness to help us made the process more efficient, more meaningful, and much more memorable. We truly appreciate the time and support he gave us as we worked to translate our students' ideas into a completed book we are proud to share.

With appreciation,

The Anachronism Club

AN AMSI INITIATIVE

THE ANACHRONISM CLUB

2025 - 2026

What if the future arrived too early?

Inside The Anachronism Club, time refuses to follow the rules. Ancient temples hide genetic secrets, Mesopotamian scribes discover the cost of the cloud, Renaissance classrooms step into virtual worlds, Cold War tensions go viral, and Harlem jazz finds a digital beat.

Each student-written story takes one historical moment and collides it with a technology that does not belong there. The result is a collection of imagination, history, warning, wonder, and creativity - all asking the same bold question: what would change if yesterday met tomorrow?

Student-written stories where history meets imagination.

Created by AMSI students.

FEATURING TIME COLLISIONS ACROSS

Ancient Greece + Genetic Engineering

Renaissance + Virtual Reality

Civil War + Drones

Exploration + Space Travel

Mesopotamia + Cloud Computing

Cold War + Social Media

Middle Ages + Smart Devices

Harlem Renaissance + Digital Music

CURATED BY THE HEADS

Rasha Daou | Maha Jarjous | Abdalrahman Al Zamqan | Omar Abdelati

Student Anthology

A collection of historical fiction, future technology, and imagination from AMSI students.

